VXIII

Mood board

Keep your savour. Matthew 5:13.

HOW THE BOARD IS READ

The board holds five reference directions, a palette and the materials. Each direction carries what we take from it and what we leave, so a reference is a discipline to follow and never a picture to copy.

DIRECTION	WHAT IT DECIDES
Pans from above	The camera angle, the hard light and the grid used in layout and packaging.
Terraces and mineral colour	The palette and the lens tints.
The hand and the rake	The pace of the photography and the tone of the copy.
Crystal and the made mark	The cube, the cut of the details and the engraving.
The frame	The wire construction and the proportions of the Navigator and the Butterfly.

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01. PANS FROM ABOVE

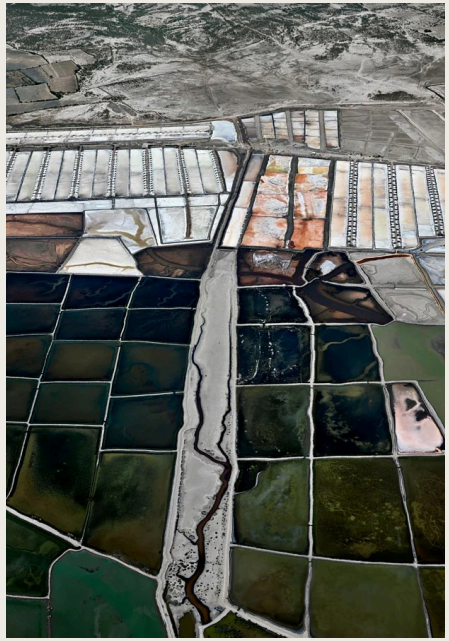
Salt begins as geometry. Sea water is divided into shallow rectangles and left to the sun, and the land turns into a drawing. This direction sets the hard light, the flat planes and the clean grid that run through the brand.



Edward Burtynsky, Salt Pans, Little Rann of Kutch, India
edwardburtynsky.com



Edward Burtynsky, Salt Pans, Little Rann of Kutch, India
edwardburtynsky.com



Edward Burtynsky, Salt Pans, Little Rann of Kutch, India
edwardburtynsky.com



Hexagonal crust, Salar de Uyuni, Bolivia (CC BY 2.0)
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What we take

The grid, the flat plane and the hard overhead light.

What we leave

The scale of industry and the machinery of the pans.

02. TERRACES AND MINERAL COLOUR

Mineral colour is the only colour taken from the earth. Maras gives stepped white and rust, and Lake Retba gives rose and brine. These places set the range of the lens tints and the warm finishes.



Salineras de Maras, Peru (CC BY-SA 4.0)
Wikimedia Commons



Salineras de Maras, Peru, panorama (CC BY-SA 4.0)
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Salt crystals from Lake Retba, Senegal (CC BY-SA 4.0)
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Salt collector, Lake Retba, Senegal (CC BY-SA 4.0)
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What we take

The range of rose, rust and white, and the stepped geometry of the terraces.

What we leave

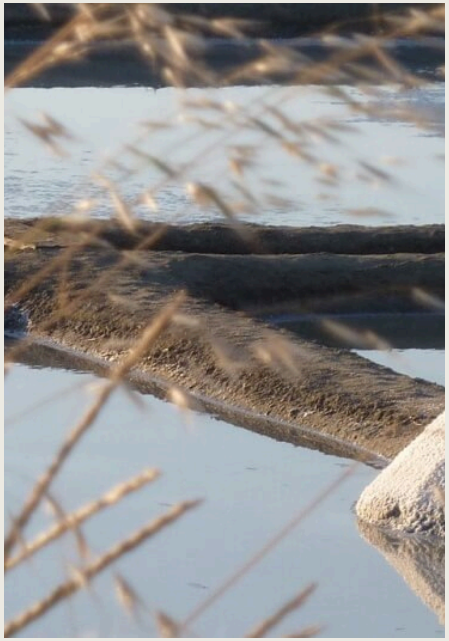
The people at work. The board concerns colour and surface.

03. THE HAND AND THE RAKE

Fleur de sel is skimmed by hand from the surface of the pan in the late afternoon. The brand takes that patience into the product and into how it is shown: close, unhurried and real.



Harvesting at Guérande, France
offbeatfrance.com



Fleur de sel at Guérande, France
offbeatfrance.com



Salt pile at the edge of the pan, Guérande, France
offbeatfrance.com



Coarse grey salt and fleur de sel (CC BY-SA 4.0)
Wikimedia Commons

What we take

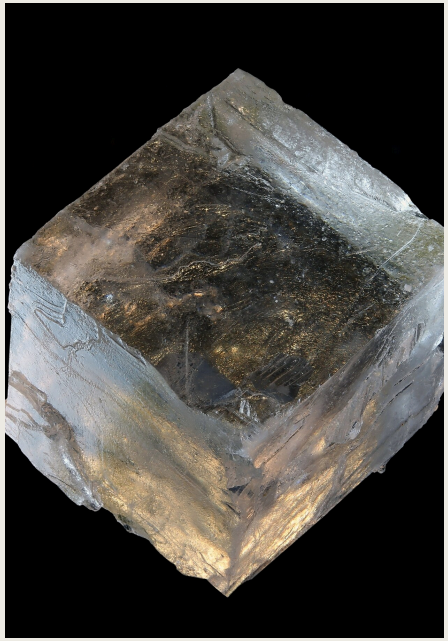
The pace and the close crop of work done by hand.

What we leave

Rustic props and baskets in frame.

04. CRYSTAL AND THE MADE MARK

The cube is the base form of the brand. Halite breaks along right angles, and the same discipline appears in Motoi Yamamoto's poured salt labyrinths, where a single material carries a whole composition.



Halite cube
Wikipedia, Halite



Stepped halite crystals
Wikipedia, Halite



Motoi Yamamoto, salt installation
trendland.com



Motoi Yamamoto, salt installation
trendland.com

What we take

Right angles, translucent edges and one material carrying the form.

What we leave

Museum specimen styling and dark backgrounds.

05. THE FRAME

Thin wire titanium, a single line around each lens, a fine bridge and temples that carry nothing except the engraving. The Navigator and the Butterfly follow the proportions and construction of these references, a restrained wire titanium frame photographed flat on a pale ground.



Wire titanium, black finish, smoke lens
fausttthebrand.com



Wire titanium, silver finish, blue lens
fausttthebrand.com



Wire titanium, gold finish, green lens
fausttthebrand.com



Wire titanium, matte black finish, amber lens
fausttthebrand.com

What we take

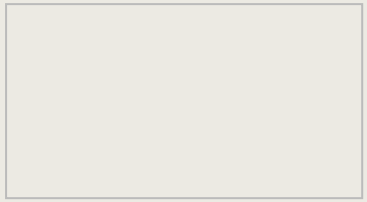
The fine wire line, the flat top-down view and the restrained proportions.

What we leave

The names, marks and temple details of the maker, which are not carried over.

PALETTE

Nine colours, each named for the salt or the metal it comes from. Salt white carries most surfaces, and the mineral colours appear only in lenses, finishes and one accent at a time.



Fleur
#ECEAE3
The first crystals off the pan. Backgrounds and paper.



Sel Gris
#8E908B
Raked grey salt. Secondary type and shadow tones.



Deep Brine
#12324F
Deep water in the pan. The packaging cloth, lid and pouch, and type.



Lava
#151515
Black lava salt. Matte black titanium and ink.



Rose
#CFA495
Rose rock salt and Lake Retba. Warm lens and rose finish.



Ambre
#B8782F
Smoked salt. Amber lens and warm gold finish.



Titanium
#B9BCBE
Polished and brushed silver finish.



Gold
#C8A25A
Warm gold titanium. The wordmark on packaging, the cube, the clip and the edges.



Gunmetal
#4A4D50
Brushed dark titanium finish.

MATERIALS

Six materials and surfaces describe the product and everything around it.

MATERIAL	DESCRIPTION	WHERE IT APPEARS
Titanium	Brushed and polished, with matte black and anodised finishes. The only metal on the frame and the reason it can be so fine.	Frame, hinge block, screws
Salt crystal	Hard right-angled edges with a cube as the base form. It governs the cut of the details and the corners of the packaging.	Temple tip, hinge block, box
Mineral colour	Lens tints taken from smoke, rose, amber and clear grey. One tint per frame.	Lenses
Paper and cloth	Uncoated off-white stock and plain cotton in the salt white of the pan.	Card, cloth, labels
Leather and book cloth	Vegetable tanned leather and book cloth in Deep Brine, with the pan and cube pattern debossed tone on tone.	Box and pouch
Engraving	A shallow cut inside the temple, in the same metal, with no filler.	Inner temple